

Dark Web Intelligence & Threats

Dark web, deep web, surface – the clarity

Surface web: indexed by search engines

Deep web: not indexed (paywalls, DB-backed content, private accounts)
– the large majority of the internet

Dark web: small overlay networks (Tor, I2P) requiring special software; anonymity-first communities

What crime looks like there

Marketplaces: stolen credentials, CC dumps, exploit kits, ransomware-as-a-service (RaaS) panels

Forums: zero-day chatter, leaked DBs, "dox" services, cybercrime tutorials

Ransomware sites: leak sites where victims' data is published

Hackers-for-hire: persistence-as-a-service, DDoS-for-pay

The defender's dark-web program

Monitor (via vetted sources/Tor + professional services):

Brand abuse (fake domains, phishing kit lineage)

Leaked corporate credentials (before they're sold again)

Ransomware mentions of your org/industry

Zero-day chatter about your stack

Dark-web monitoring tools (defensive)

Professional services: Recorded Future, Flashpoint, IntelligenceX, Dehashed (also feeds)

Open: ThreatFox (abuse.ch), MalwareBazaar samples, Ahmia (search engine over .onion, legal to read), OnionScan (historical)

Internal: OSINT triage dashboards + alerting on key phrases

Ethics & legality

Reading market listings to understand intel = generally lawful (via Tor public)

Buying/brokerage or facilitating = serious crime

Balance: the surveillance-inverse – the same skills that spot leaked credentials could (if untethered) invade privacy. Scope and purpose keep it professional.

The dark web is 90% noise and 10% high-value signals. Professional practice is filtering: brand, creds, ransomware, zero-day mention – alerted into your workflow, not doom-scrolled.

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